lacked the training needed to take on terror cases, are poorly paid and did not have the resources to carry out their jobs successfully,' said Muhammad Jahangir, the chief prosecutor in Punjab. The state had been unable to properly prosecute the terrorists. Resultantly, most of them were exonerated and they rejoined the terrorist groups to restart the activities with renewed vigour. In the first seven months of 2011, the three anti-terrorism courts (ATC) of Rawalpindi acquitted 56 suspects involved in 96 terrorism cases. The large number of acquittals was mainly due to insipid investigation. Proper evidence was not presented in the court. As far as prosecutors were concerned, they worked in fear without adequate security. As one prosecutor put it, 'terrorists threaten us. They are influential and well-informed' (*Dawn Editorial*, 2011). Similarly, witnesses were also deeply scared of terrorists' backlash. Only the Sindh government had introduced a Witness Protection System in Pakistan. The Punjab government was following the suit but a draft was pending in the files due to bureaucratic red-tapism.

There were laws such as the Anti-Terrorism Act, 1997, and the Security of Pakistan Act, 1952, which had provisions to control and suspend activities of proscribed and subversive organisations. However, they lacked depth and strength to take the concept to its logical conclusion. The law did not automatically produce any serious penal consequences for an organisation that is declared subversive or proscribed. The state was not obliged to identify the members of such an organisation, prevent them from reorganising themselves under a new banner, prohibit them from purchasing property, renting houses and vehicles and so on.

The acts such as the Protection of Pakistan Act, POPA 2014 and amendments in Section 21 EEEE of the Anti-Terrorist Act were passed to assist the law enforcement agencies. Besides, the 21st Amendment to the Constitution was passed, which constitutionalised the creation of military courts parallel to the regular courts. Although such legislative measures were flouting fundamental rights, they were needed at the time as Pakistan was facing extraordinary circumstances. However, the POPA was not in force and the 21st Amendment was supposed to expire after the lapse of two years due to the sunset clause. No serious and long-lasting efforts were made in reforming the judicial system until the end of 2017, as was decided while passing the 21st Amendment.